

NEW BOOTS ON THE GROUND
Indian army personnel attending the foundation stone laying ceremony at the Lachit Borphukan Military Station in Bamuni, Assam, Nov. 7, 2025

DEFENCE
SILIGURI CORRIDOR

A MORE MUSCULAR CHICKEN'S NECK

THE SILIGURI CORRIDOR, INDIA'S VULNERABLE LAND LINK TO ITS NORTHEAST, IS UNDER THREAT FROM A NEW BANGLADESH-PAKISTAN-CHINA MILITARY-STRATEGIC AXIS. NOW, THREE NEW ARMY GARRISONS ARE READY TO MEET ANY HOSTILE ACTION

By PRADIP R. SAGAR

A shadow looms over the Siliguri Corridor in North Bengal, also called the 'Chicken's Neck'—India's 22-km-wide and 60-km-long land bridge linking the mainland to its eight Northeastern states—and the Indian military has risen to dispel it.

Sandwiched between Nepal, Bhutan and Bangladesh, with the China border nearby, it hosts key security, logistics and trading facilities. This fragile strategic artery is a chokepoint whose disruption could sever the region from the rest of the country. Over the past 12 months, Beijing and Islamabad have dramatically expanded their military-strategic footprint—including near the corridor—in Bangladesh following the August 2024 ouster of the Sheikh Hasina regime, triggering a rethink within India's security establishment. The traditional Border Security Force (BSF)-heavy deployment was deemed insufficient for the emerging threat. The response has been swift and muscular: three new Indian Army garrisons around the corridor overlooking the Bangladesh frontier. The objective is to enhance surveillance and boost rapid response capabilities.

The most significant of the new installations is the Lachit Borphu-